

Black Lab Linux OS out with its latest 32-bit KDE version



32-bit support for operating systems is coming to an end all over the world. But the Black Lab Linux development team has chosen to buck the trend. The developers have announced on Twitter that they have released a fresh 32-bit version of the KDE-based distribution, which will support installations of the Black Lab Linux KDE Edition 6.0 SR1 operating system on low-end computers with older hardware components. The tweet reads, "Black Lab Linux 32 bit is released. Min. requirements: 32-bit processor with PAE support, 768MB of RAM, 10GB HD, <https://sourceforge.net/projects/os4online/files/Rel6/...>"

Until now, Black Lab Linux has always distributed 64-bit images. Both the 64-bit and 32-bit images are based on the Kubuntu 14.04 LTS operating system and built around the KDE Applications 4.14.2 graphical desktop environment.

The 32-bit Black Lab Linux KDE version looks completely different from the 64-bit variant. It uses a lightweight theme for the desktop, a slim *Start* menu and gorgeous wallpaper. The packages are optimised only for 32-bit computers. The preinstalled open source applications are the same on both ISO images, though. Users will be able to browse using Mozilla Firefox, view and organise photo albums with digiKam and edit images with the GIMP. This version has the Pidgin messaging client, the Steam for Linux gaming engine, the Mozilla Thunderbird email client, the movie player Dragon Player and the office suite LibreOffice.

Those with a 32-bit processor with Physical Address Extension support, 768MB RAM and 10GB disk space can use the Black Lab Linux KDE 32-bit operating system.

Microsoft is slowly open sourcing the entire .NET Core server-side stack, the latest being the release of the source code for .NET Core Common Language Runtime (CLR). This release is quite similar to the November release of the .NET CoreFX repo. The latest release includes full CoreCLR,

GitHub

which is the 'execution engine' for .NET Core and other .NET runtime components. While CoreFX is completely C#, CoreCLR is a combination of C# and C++ code. Multiple

toolsets are being used in CoreCLR to build both C# and C++. When Visual Studio is not shipped, Microsoft depends on CMake, which is again an open source cross-platform build system.

Well, how does this latest development impact you? Very soon, ASP.NET 5 Web apps, services as well as console apps can be built. Microsoft is already working on pushing a single operating system for all devices with a single app store, and with this latest move, the unified ecosystem strategy has moved a step further towards reality. As Microsoft has announced, several more milestones are to be achieved on the open source and cross-platform .NET runtime and server-side stack.

BackBox Linux's latest version out with a few major improvements

A new version has been announced for BackBox Linux, which is based on



Ubuntu 14.04.1 LTS. This distro is used for penetration testing and security assessments. The latest version is now available for further upgrades and testing.

The latest 4.x branch of BackBox Linux was made available in October and now the first update has been released. Developers

have made a few improvements to it, as well as to the Linux kernel and core packages. There are not many distros that can perform penetration testing properly, other than Kali, DEFT and BackTrack.

Apart from penetration tests and security assessments, the BackBox distro also integrates a user-friendly desktop environment, based on Xfce. As mentioned by the developers on the official website, "The BackBox team is pleased to announce the updated release of BackBox Linux, version 4.1! This release includes features such as Linux Kernel 3.13, EFI mode, Anonymous mode, an LVM + Disk encryption installer, privacy additions and armhf Debian packages."

This distribution uses Ubuntu 14.04.1 as its base currently, and the installer has LVM and 'full disk encryption' options. Custom actions have been added to the file manager, Thunar, and the Anonymous mode has been refined to increase its efficiency. ARM architecture is also now supported and a few hacking tools have been added.

Librem 15 Linux laptop tastes initial success

Librem 15, which is currently one of the most talked-about Linux-powered laptops, has achieved stupendous success in its crowd-funding campaign, having raised 50 per cent more funds than initially targeted. The laptop will ship with completely free applications, drivers and kernel.